such as ease of test maintenance and better collaboration with developers. After all, writing automated tests is a software development activity.

Because it will be difficult to cover all the programming languages that Pact supports, this chapter will focus on how to set up pact-js, which is the JavaScript version. As the online documentation is likely to be more up-to-date with implementation changes on how to use their API, make sure to always check their documentation for more information (https://mng.bz/5OGz).

### 4.2.1 Requirements

To follow along in this step-by-step tutorial, you need to have the following installed in your machines:

- Node (LTS version)
- Git and GitHub account (optional, but preferred to have so your changes are tracked)
- Visual Studio Code (VS Code; or other visual code editor, but we'll show the examples using VS Code)

For comprehensive installation details of Node and pact-js, refer to appendix B, specifically sections B.1 and B.2.

To make this easier, we've created an example GitHub project, https://github.com/mdcruz/pact-js-example/, that you can download or fork online using Git. Feel free to jump to the next section if you already know how to fork the project or download it. If you need additional guidelines on how to fork or download the project, refer to appendix B, specifically sections B.3 or B.4. Once you have a copy of this GitHub project in your local machines, switch to a new branch called `setup-contract-tests-consumer` by running the following command:

```
git checkout setup-contract-tests-consumer
```